

1.4.1 Coordinate Systems

Transformations can take place along a number of user selectable XYZ coordinate systems. These change how the transform gizmo is oriented relative to the object. 3ds Max has several types of coordinate systems, including View, Screen, World, and Parent.

1.4.2 Pivots

A pivot is located at the centre of each object's coordinate system, which is particularly important when rotating an object, because the object will rotate around the pivot. Pivots are managed in the Command panel under the Pivot panel of the Hierarchy tab. When the pivot is placed outside the wheel, the wheel rotates around its edge. When the pivot is in the centre of the wheel, it rotates around the axle.

Pivot panel – This panel contains tools to adjust an object's pivot.

Affect Pivot Only – Allows you to move the position of the pivot.

Affect Object Only – Allows you to move the object while the pivot remains stationary.

Affect Hierarchy Only – Applies the rotation or scale to the hierarchy by rotating or scaling the position of the pivot point without rotating or scaling the pivot point itself.

Center To Object – Moves the pivot to the center of its object.

Align To Object – Rotates the pivot to align with the object's transformation axis.

Align To World – Rotates the pivot to align with the world axis.

Hierarchy tab – The Pivot panel is located under the Hierarchy tab.

Reset Pivot – Resets the pivot to when the object was first created.



The Pivot menu under the Hierarchy Tab in the Command Panel